

about saying something silly like, “Hello, I’d like my 401(k) rolled over to my new job, please.” Turns out that’s exactly what to say. Get a statement of your account. Log into the site to see what’s happening in your 401(k). Find out what investments are in it. Find out what investment firm your company is using, and what fees it is charging to look after your money. Make sure you’re not overpaying in fees on your 401(k). Fees can include plan administration fees like the costs of upkeep on the 401(k), like accounting and record keeping, or individual service fees. The biggest of the fees might be an investment fee that varies depending on the particular investments you’re making in your 401(k), as well as sales and commissions fees. The information about fees can be found in your 401(k)’s breakdown, also called a prospectus. According to *Business Insider*, the long, often dense document “should lay out expenses associated with various investment options, as well as the past investment performance.” You can also find this information in your company’s benefits booklet, which they are required to have on hand. [HumanInterest.com](https://www.humaninterest.com/401k-fees/) listed 1.37 percent of assets invested in the plan as an average fee. If you feel your fees are too high, you can look into the contents of your 401(k) and figure out other alternatives.

IRA

An individual retirement account is not tied to employment, so it’s usually good for freelancers. The website The Motley Fool writes that traditional IRAs don’t have income restrictions, so anyone, regardless of income, can contribute to one as a retirement plan. As with a 401(k), the contributions are tax deductible, but you have to pay taxes whenever you make withdrawals.

You can make contributions to the plan only until the age of 70½. It’s a good option if you work a job that doesn’t offer a 401(k) or are a freelancer, and you’re going to be contributing only a few thousand dollars each year (in 2018, the limit for people under 50 is \$5,500).

ROTH IRA

Unlike a 401(k) or traditional IRA, Roth IRA contributions *are* taxed, but withdrawals *are not* taxed—so you basically never have to pay taxes on the portion of the account that is return on investment (what you’ve earned)—just